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VOL. 12 · ST. ANDREW SOUTH WEST

Lennox Andrews Digs In: How the NNP Lost Ground in St. Andrew South West

The NNP won St. Andrew South West in 2013 and 2018 and lost it narrowly in 2022. In 2026 the NDC's majority more than doubled to 1,094. The NNP carried one polling division out of 20, and turnout fell nine points.

BY GREG HOSTEN ST. ANDREW SOUTH WEST, GRENADA

ST. ANDREW SOUTH WEST, GRENADA— St. Andrew South West has changed hands with the national tide. The NDC's Sylvester Quarless won it in 2008. The NNP's Yolande Bain-Horsford took it in 2013 and held it in 2018. In 2022 the NDC's Lennox Andrews won it back, by 2,129 votes to 1,704.

> **"The NDC did not need to win over NNP voters. It needed them to stay home, and many did."**
> GREG HOSTEN

On 5 November Mr. Andrews was re-elected by 2,428 votes to 1,334 for the NNP's Amanda Japal, in a straight two-way contest. A majority of 425 became 1,094. A seat the NNP held for nine years now looks like settled NDC ground.

A NEW CARETAKER, 19 MONTHS OUT

The NNP named Ms. Japal as its caretaker for St. Andrew South West in April 2025, one of four caretakers presented that month for seats the party lost in 2022. She had about 19 months before polling day to become known across a constituency of almost 6,000 voters, running from the edge of Grenville through Munich, Grand Bras, St. James and Harford Village to Birchgrove and Mount Carmel.

Against her was a sitting member with four years in the seat. The NNP's share of the two-party vote fell from 44.5 per cent to 35.5 per cent, a drop of 9.0 points, slightly less than the national swing of 10.3.

THE NNP LOST VOTERS; THE NDC KEPT ITS OWN

The NNP's vote fell by 370, from 1,704 to 1,334. The NDC's rose by 299. Measured against the whole electorate, Mr. Andrews won the votes of 40.0 per cent of all registered voters in 2022 and 40.7 per cent in 2026, almost unchanged. The NNP's share fell from 32.0 per cent to 22.4 per cent.

That pattern repeats across this series. Sitting NDC members held their share of the electorate steady, while the NNP's support drained away. The NDC did not need to win over NNP voters. It needed them to stay home, and many did.

FEWER VOTERS THAN IN 2022

St. Andrew South West's register grew by 635 names, but 80 fewer ballots were cast. Turnout fell from 72.4 per cent to 63.3 per cent, a drop of 9.0 points, the third-largest in the country. This year 2,187 registered voters did not vote, up from 1,472.

With no third party on the ballot, every one of those missing votes was a choice not to vote at all. In a seat the NNP held as recently as 2018, a fall in turnout of this size points to a party that did not reach its own supporters.

ONE DIVISION LEFT

The NNP carried 1 of the 20 polling divisions: the Walker Church of God, by 73 votes to 64. It came closest elsewhere at the Union Community Centre, with 45.4 per cent of the two-party vote, and at the Grenville Pre-Primary School, with 41.3 per cent across two divisions, including the largest division in the seat.

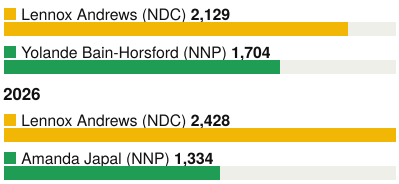
Its weakest results were at Mount Carmel, with 25.6 per cent, Grand Bras, with 25.8 per cent across two divisions, and Harford Village, with 28.7 per cent. At St. James the NDC won 203 votes to 102. At the two Forde divisions it won 238 to 119.

FIVE HUNDRED AND FORTY-EIGHT VOTERS

To win the seat back, the NNP needs 548 voters to switch sides, or 1,095 more of its own supporters to turn out, half of those who stayed home. That is a substantial gap, but St. Andrew South West has swung by this

2022 VS 2026

Votes by candidate, in party colours



1,094 votes
NDC winning margin in 2026

BY THE NUMBERS

1,094
NDC winning margin, up from 425 in 2022

1 of 20
Polling divisions won by the NNP

–9.0 pts
Fall in turnout, the third-largest in the country

–370
Fall in the NNP vote since 2022

much before, in both directions.

Recovering the NNP's 2022 vote of 1,704 alone would cut the deficit by about a third. Recovering the 2018 position would require a candidate who is known and present for years, not months.

WHAT CAN BE DONE: A FOUR-YEAR PLAN FOR THE SOUTH-WEST

St. Andrew South West needs continuity first.

Year one, 2027: confirm the candidate early, whether Ms. Japal or another, and commit to that person for two elections. Open a permanent office near Grenville, where the two largest polling divisions are, and keep it open between elections.

Year two, 2028: build out from Walker, Union and the Grenville Pre-Primary divisions, where the NNP did best. Hold regular meetings in Grand Bras, Harford Village and Mount Carmel, where it did worst, with farmers, transport operators and young families. Register new voters every month: 635 joined the roll.

Year three, 2029: recruit a captain for each of the 20 divisions. Track contacts against the 2022 NNP vote in each division, and report progress publicly to party members.

Year four, 2030: run the campaign as a turnout operation. The first target is to restore the 2022 vote of 1,704. The second is to win back the divisions the NNP held when it last won the seat.

THE LESSON FOR EVERY NNP SEAT

St. Andrew South West shows the cost of naming caretakers late in seats lost the previous time. The NNP lost here narrowly in 2022, then waited almost three years to name its new caretaker, and lost by much more in 2026.

The four years after a defeat are when a seat is won or lost. Every lost NNP seat should have its candidate in place within the first year of the new Parliament, not the third.

THE ARITHMETIC OF ST. ANDREW SOUTH WEST

Measure	2022	2026	Change
NNP votes	1,704	1,334	−370
NDC votes	2,129	2,428	+299
NNP share of two-party vote	44.5%	35.5%	−9.0 pts
NNP two-party share nationally	48.0%	37.7%	−10.3 pts
Winning margin	NDC +425	NDC +1,094	
Registered voters	5,327	5,962	+635
Ballots cast	3,855	3,775	−80
Turnout	72.4%	63.3%	−9.0 pts
Registered voters who did not vote	1,472	2,187	+715
NNP votes as a share of all registered voters	32.0%	22.4%	−9.6 pts
Polling divisions won by the NNP		1 of 20	
Switchers the NNP needed to win		548	

Straight two-party contest in both years. 2026 figures are provisional results from the Parliamentary Elections Office, all 20 polling divisions verified.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR 2030/31

1. Name the caretaker in year one, not year three.
2. Commit to one candidate for two elections.
3. Watch turnout: it fell nine points, the third-largest drop.
4. Build out from Walker, Union and the Grenville divisions.
5. Do not write off Grand Bras, Harford Village or Mount Carmel.
6. Keep a permanent office near Grenville.
7. Captain all 20 divisions, with targets from the 2022 vote.
8. Restore the 2022 vote of 1,704 as the first milestone.

Sources: Parliamentary Elections Office live results, live.elections.gd (2026, provisional; polling divisions read 9 Nov 2026); Wikipedia (2008, 2013 and 2022 general elections); NOW Grenada / Caribbean Focus (NNP caretakers, Apr 2025); NOW Grenada (2018 caretakers; 2026 results). Analytics computed by the author from the published counts. Analysis by Greg Hosten, Vol. 12 of a weekly constituency series. Written in the style of a newspaper report; not a publication of any news organisation.